

Monday, 6 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

33° 19°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

29° 17°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

20° 16°

GLASGOW

Light drizzle

17° 14°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 A convicted fraudster and aristocrat is reportedly at the centre of a new controversy involving Nigel Farage.

The 32-year-old, known as 'Posh George', is a long-time associate of Mr Farage and was previously convicted of fraud in the US. Details are emerging about his alleged involvement in a crypto venture.

POLITICS · UK

2 The NHS app is set to use Artificial Intelligence to help patients find the best health service for their needs.

This new update will be rolled out to all users in England by April 2028. It aims to streamline access to healthcare and improve patient navigation.

HEALTH · UK

3 A sanction has been authorised against the Ministry of Defence after two soldiers died in a tank explosion.

Corporal Darren Neilson and Corporal Matthew Hatfield tragically lost their lives during an incident involving a Challenger 2 tank. The explosion occurred at Castlemartin Range.

DEFENCE · UK

4 A convicted people smuggler has been tracked down by the BBC, reportedly living in Leicestershire and working illegally.

The individual is also said to be seeking asylum in the UK. This revelation raises questions about the effectiveness of current border controls.

IMMIGRATION · UK

5 Two people have been arrested on suspicion of murder after a man was fatally stabbed in west London.

Haruun Hassan, 22, died in the early hours of Tuesday morning following the attack. Police are continuing their investigation into the incident.

CRIME · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Taylor Swift and Travis Kelce tied the knot in a star-studded New York ceremony over the weekend!**
The A-list couple exchanged vows in a celebration that saw several Midtown Manhattan streets shut down. Adam Sandler reportedly officiated the wedding, with hordes of fans gathering outside.
ON AIR – What's the most surprising celebrity wedding you can remember?
CELEBRITY · NOW
- 2 There's big news for TV fans, with an announcement expected soon about Sky potentially buying ITV's channels!**
This could mean big changes for some of your favourite shows and how you watch them. It's certainly a shake-up in the broadcasting world.
ON AIR – If Sky buys ITV, what's one show you hope stays exactly the same?
TV · SOON
- 3 The Specials' final album, recorded from their 2019 Coventry Cathedral performances, is being released this month.**
It's being hailed as a fitting tribute to the band's late frontman, Terry Hall. Fans can look forward to hearing these live recordings.
ON AIR – What's your favourite Specials song, and what memories does it bring back?
MUSIC · THIS MONTH
- 4 Harlesden in north-west London has launched a new Reggae Walk of Fame, celebrating its rich musical heritage!**
The trail honours the area's reggae pioneers and Windrush generation. It's a fantastic way to recognise their cultural contributions.
ON AIR – Which British town or city do you think has the best musical heritage?
CULTURE · NOW
- 5 Star Wars fans are flocking to a seaside town near Blackpool, where Stormtroopers are patrolling the beach!**
It's a yearly gathering for fans of the Star Wars prequel 'Andor', which was filmed in the area. A great excuse for a themed day out!
ON AIR – If you could visit any real-life filming location, which one would it be?
FILM · NOW

On the schedule

- 1 **Charles Leclerc has won a dramatic British Grand Prix, with George Russell taking second place!**
It was a thrilling race at Silverstone where both Kimi Antonelli and Max Verstappen failed to score points. A fantastic result for the home crowd with Russell on the podium!
ON AIR – Are you happy with the result, or were you rooting for someone else?
F1 · UK

- 2 **Australia has taken full control of the ICC Women's T20 World Cup final at Lord's against England.**
Heather Knight was dismissed for just two runs, leaving England struggling at 70-4. It's a crushing blow for the home side in a crucial match.
ON AIR – Do you think England can still turn this around, or is it Australia's to lose?
CRICKET · UK

- 3 **British wildcard Arthur Fery has fought off nosebleeds and Zizou Bergs to win a five-set epic at Wimbledon!**
Fery's incredible victory means he's reached the fourth round, keeping home singles hopes alive. What a performance in a gruelling match!
ON AIR – How far do you think Arthur Fery can go in the tournament after that amazing win?
TENNIS · UK

- 4 **Alexandra Eala has dedicated her stunning Wimbledon victory over defending champion Iga Swiatek to 'all the girls with ruffled socks and chubby cheeks'!**
It was an emotional win, and her dedication is a lovely touch. She's certainly made a name for herself at this year's tournament.
ON AIR – What's the most memorable dedication you've ever heard from a sportsperson?
TENNIS · UK

- 5 **England's losing streak continues after a brutal defeat by South Africa in the rugby.**
While losing to the Springboks can happen, England desperately need to find a way to stop this run of defeats. It's a tough time for Steve Borthwick's side.
ON AIR – What do England need to change to get back to winning ways in rugby?
RUGBY · UK

Quick hits

- 1 The surprising pleasure of a perfectly organised pantry is gaining traction.**
A recent lifestyle trend highlights how a well-arranged food cupboard can bring a surprising sense of calm and control to daily life, making meal prep a joy.
- 2 Scientists have found that listening to the sound of rain can genuinely lower stress levels.**
Research indicates that the gentle, repetitive sound of rainfall creates a soothing auditory environment, promoting relaxation and reducing anxiety for many.
- 3 The simple act of writing a letter is making a heartfelt comeback.**
Amidst digital overload, more people are rediscovering the personal touch and lasting sentiment of handwritten correspondence, finding joy in sending and receiving physical mail.
- 4 A study reveals that people who regularly visit local markets report higher levels of happiness.**
The social interaction, fresh produce, and unique atmosphere of a market trip contribute to a sense of community and well-being, according to new findings.
- 5 The charm of collecting vinyl records is experiencing a noticeable resurgence.**
Music enthusiasts are increasingly drawn to the tactile experience and warmer sound of vinyl, turning record collecting into a popular and nostalgic hobby once more.
- 6 British gardeners are finding unexpected joy in growing their own herbs at home.**
From windowsills to small patios, cultivating fresh herbs offers a rewarding and practical hobby, adding flavour to dishes and a touch of green to living spaces.
- 7 Researchers are noting the positive impact of 'forest bathing' on mental health.**
Spending mindful time among trees, known as shinrin-yoku, is being recognised for its ability to reduce stress hormones and improve mood, connecting us with nature.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what with our toast, even if we know it's a bit odd?

ANSWER: CUTTING OFF THE CRUSTS, EVEN AS AN ADULT!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'route' they absolutely have to take when walking around their local area. What's special about it?

ANSWER: IT ALLOWS THEM TO SPOT ALL THE NEIGHBOURHOOD CATS!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you rediscover an 'old board game' from your childhood and it's surprisingly fun to play again?

What's that one classic board game that instantly takes you back, and do you still play it now?

- We all have those 'unusual items' that we keep in our kitchen drawers – not quite sure why, but they're always there, aren't they?

What's the most surprising or inexplicable thing you've got lurking in your kitchen junk drawer?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that oak trees don't start producing acorns until they are at least 50 years old?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The Northern Lights can sometimes be heard as a crackling sound, rather than just seen, due to atmospheric electrical discharges.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£5 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£5 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of owls is called a 'parliament'.
- The inventor of the Pringles can is buried in one.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896; it lasted only 38 minutes.
- Bananas are technically berries, but strawberries are not.
- There are more permutations of a standard deck of 52 playing cards than there are atoms on Earth.
- The 'sixth sick sheik's sixth sheep's sick' is thought to be the toughest tongue twister in the English language.
- The world's largest snowflake ever recorded was 15 inches wide and 8 inches thick, falling in Montana in 1887.
- The human eye can distinguish approximately 10 million different colours.

On this day

Day 187 of the year, 178 days left in 2026. Today The first day of the Festival of San Fermin, which lasts until July 14. (Pamplona); Christian feast day: Goar of Aquitaine; Christian feast day: Maria Goretti; Christian feast day: Blessed Mary Theresa Ledóchowska. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1980 — Joell Ortiz, American rapper
- 1939 — Mary Peters, English-Irish pentathlete and shot putter
- 1979 — Kevin Hart, American comedian, actor, producer, and screenwriter
- 1998 — Comethazine, American rapper
- 1937 — Ned Beatty, American actor (died 2021)
- 1946 — Sylvester Stallone, American actor, director, and screenwriter
- 1978 — Tia Mowry, American actress and producer
- 1949 — Phyllis Hyman, American singer-songwriter and actress (died 1995)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1947 — Referendum held in Sylhet to decide its fate in the Partition of India.
- 1962 — The Late Late Show, the world's longest-running chat show by the same broadcaster, airs on RTÉ One for the first time.
- 2013 — A 73-car oil train derails in the town of Lac-Mégantic, Quebec and explodes into flames, killing at least 47 people and destroying more than 30 buildings in the town's central area.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1966 — Malawi becomes a republic, with Hastings Banda as its first President.
- 2006 — The Nathu La pass between India and China, sealed during the Sino-Indian War, re-opens for trade after 44 years.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1947 — Referendum held in Sylhet to decide its fate in the Partition of India.
- 1996 — A McDonnell Douglas MD-88 operating as Delta Air Lines Flight 1288 experiences a turbine engine failure during takeoff from Pensacola International Airport, killing two and injuring five of the 147 people on board.

- 1942 — Anne Frank and her family go into hiding in the "Secret Annexe" above her father's office in an Amsterdam warehouse.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 188 of the year, 177 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Æthelburh of Faremoutiers; Christian feast day: Felix of Nantes; Christian feast day: Illidius; Christian feast day: Job of Manyava (Ukrainian Orthodox Church). Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1965 — Jeremy Kyle, English talk show host
- 1988 — Kaci Brown, American singer-songwriter
- 1969 — Cree Summer, American-Canadian actress
- 1965 — Mo Collins, American actress, comedian and screenwriter
- 1968 — Jorja Fox, American actress
- 1972 — Kirsten Vangsness, American actress and writer
- 1970 — Min Patel, Indian-English cricketer
- 1957 — Jonathan Dayton, American director and producer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1963 — Buddhist crisis: Police commanded by Ngô Đình Nhu, brother and chief political adviser of South Vietnam President Ngo Dinh Diem, attacked a group of American journalists who were covering a protest.
- 1959 — Venus occults the star Regulus. This rare event is used to determine the diameter of Venus and the structure of the Venusian atmosphere.
- 2022 — Boris Johnson announces his resignation as leader of the Conservative Party following days of pressure from the Members of Parliament (MPs) during the July 2022 United Kingdom government crisis.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1952 — The ocean liner SS United States passes Bishop Rock on her maiden voyage, breaking the transatlantic speed record to become the fastest passenger ship in the world.
- 1963 — Buddhist crisis: Police commanded by Ngô Đình Nhu, brother and chief political adviser of South Vietnam President Ngo Dinh Diem, attacked a group of American journalists who were covering a protest.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026

FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)